

You are an expert operations analyst and logic puzzle solver.
Solve the following fintech operations logic puzzle using a structured elimination approach.

Instructions:

1. Read all clues carefully before making any assumptions.
2. Create a matrix showing every analyst, transaction count, and tool.
3. For each clue, explain exactly what it confirms and what it eliminates.
4. Update the matrix after every clue.
5. Never guess—only make deductions that logically follow from the available information.
6. If multiple possibilities remain, explicitly state them before moving to the next clue.
7. At the end, provide:
 - o A final table showing each analyst, their tool, and transactions cleared.
 - o A short proof explaining why no other solution is possible.
 - o A verification checklist confirming every clue is satisfied.

Present the reasoning clearly enough that someone with no background in logic puzzles can follow it.

Puzzle:

Four Nium ops analysts—Ana, Ben, Chen, and Dara—each cleared a different number of transactions today (12, 18, 25, or 31), each using a different tool (spreadsheet, internal dashboard, script, or ticketing queue).

Using the clues below, determine each analyst's tool and transaction count:

1. Ana cleared more transactions than the analyst using the spreadsheet, but fewer than the one using the script.
2. The analyst using the ticketing queue cleared exactly 18 transactions.
3. Chen used the internal dashboard and cleared more transactions than Dara.
4. Ben did not use the script and cleared fewer transactions than Chen.

5. Dara did not use the ticketing queue.